infection prevention control policy

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Infection Prevention & Control Policy

Policy Title: Infection Prevention & Control

1. Policy Statement

At [INSERT CARE HOME NAME], we are committed to maintaining the highest standards of infection prevention and control to protect residents, staff, and visitors from avoidable infections.

We aim to:

- Prevent and reduce infections through effective hygiene and control measures
- Comply with statutory requirements, including the Health and Social Care Act 2008 (Regulated Activities) Regulations 2014
- Promote a culture of safety, vigilance, and continuous improvement

2. Purpose

This policy sets out the principles and procedures to prevent and control infections within [INSERT CARE HOME NAME], including:

- Hand hygiene
- Use of personal protective equipment (PPE)
- Cleaning and environmental control
- Managing outbreaks and reporting incidents
- Staff training and education

3. Scope

This policy applies to:

- All employees, agency staff, contractors, volunteers
- Residents and their visitors
- All areas of the care home environment

4. Roles and Responsibilities

Registered Manager:

- Ensures implementation and monitoring of the IPC policy
- Reports serious infections or outbreaks to the relevant health authorities and CQC
- Ensures staff have appropriate training and access to PPE

Infection Control Lead (if applicable):

- Oversees IPC practices and audits
- Acts as the key contact for infection control matters

All Staff:

- Follow IPC protocols and complete mandatory training
- Report suspected infections immediately
- Practice good hand hygiene and PPE use

5. Key Infection Prevention Measures

5.1 Hand Hygiene

- Staff must wash hands thoroughly with soap and water or use alcohol-based hand sanitiser:
- Before and after resident contact
- After removing gloves or PPE
- After using the toilet
- Before preparing or handling food

5.2 Personal Protective Equipment (PPE)

- Use appropriate PPE according to risk assessment and guidance (e.g., gloves, aprons, masks)
- PPE must be correctly put on and removed to prevent contamination
- Dispose of used PPE safely in designated waste bins

5.3 Cleaning and Environmental Hygiene

- Follow the cleaning schedule for all areas, including residents' rooms, communal spaces, and bathrooms
- Use approved disinfectants for high-touch surfaces
- Maintain laundry hygiene procedures to avoid cross-contamination

5.4 Waste Management

- Dispose of clinical and domestic waste in line with local authority regulations
- Sharps to be disposed of in approved sharps containers

6. Managing Infection and Outbreaks

- Immediate isolation of suspected or confirmed infectious cases
- Notify the local Health Protection Team and CQC as required
- Implement outbreak control measures, including enhanced cleaning and visitor restrictions
- Conduct thorough contact tracing and risk assessments

7. Staff Health and Immunisation

- Staff must report any infections or illnesses that could risk transmission
- Staff are encouraged to have relevant vaccinations, including seasonal flu and COVID-19 boosters
- Policies in place for staff exclusion from work during infectious illness

8. Training and Education

- All staff receive mandatory IPC training at induction
- Annual refresher training is required for all clinical and care staff
- Updates provided as new guidance or outbreaks occur

9. Monitoring and Audit

- Regular hand hygiene and IPC practice audits will be conducted
- Environmental cleanliness inspections and documentation reviews
- Incident reports and outbreak data reviewed to identify improvements

10. References

- Health and Social Care Act 2008 (Regulated Activities) Regulations 2014
- NICE Guideline NG125 – Healthcare-associated infections
- Public Health England (PHE) Infection Prevention and Control Guidance
- CQC Fundamental Standards – Regulation 12 (Safe Care and Treatment)

11. Related Policies

- Hand Hygiene Policy
- Personal Protective Equipment (PPE) Policy
- Cleaning and Environmental Hygiene Policy
- Outbreak Management Policy
- Staff Health and Wellbeing Policy
- Waste Management Policy

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